

FIND YOUR WHY

Sermon #3

January 30, 2022

TEXT: Acts 17:22-32 (NKJV) *“Then Paul stood in the midst of the Areopagus (Mars Hill) and said, “Men of Athens, I perceive that in all things you are very religious; ²³ for as I was passing through and considering the objects of your worship, I even found an altar with this inscription:*

TO THE UNKNOWN GOD.

Therefore, the One whom you worship without knowing, Him I proclaim to you: ²⁴ God, who made the world and everything in it, since He is Lord of heaven and earth, does not dwell in temples made with hands. ²⁵ Nor is He worshiped with men’s hands, as though He needed anything, since He gives to all life, breath, and all things. ²⁶ And He has made from one ^{li} blood every nation of men to dwell

on all the face of the earth, and has determined their pre-appointed times and the boundaries of their dwellings, ²⁷ so that they should seek the Lord, in the hope that they might grope for Him and find Him, though He is not far from each one of us; ²⁸ for in Him we live and move and have our being, as also some of your own poets have said, ‘For we are also His offspring. ²⁹ Therefore, since we are the offspring of God, we ought not to think that the Divine Nature is like gold or silver or stone, something shaped by art and man’s devising. ³⁰ Truly, these times of ignorance God overlooked, but now commands all men everywhere to repent, ³¹ because He has appointed a day on which He will judge the world in righteousness by the Man whom He has ordained. He has given assurance of this to all by raising Him from the dead.’ ³² And when they heard of the resurrection of the dead, some mocked, while others said, “We will hear you again on this matter.” ³³ So Paul departed from among them.”

INTRO: It is absolutely imperative to be “*In Him*” to understand and fulfill our “WHY”.

At Athens Paul said that it is, “*In Him we live and move and have our being; For we are also His offspring.*” Paul’s words on this subject sound very similar to the words of the prophet Jeremiah several hundred years prior. Jeremiah 1:4-5 “*Then the word of the Lord came to me, saying, 5 Before I formed you in the womb I knew [and] approved of you [as My chosen instrument], and before you were born I separated and set you apart, consecrating you; [and] I appointed you as a prophet to the nations.*”

The writer of Acts weighs in on the subject stating in Acts 17:26 “*From one man, Adam, he made every man and woman and every race of humanity, and he spread us over all the earth. He sets the boundaries of people and nations, determining their appointed times in history.*”

The Psalmist makes it even more personal in Psalm 139:13 “*You did form my inward parts; You did knit me together in my mother’s womb.*”

The Bible is very clear on the subject of our “WHY”. We come to this earth and live until death takes us out. The last enemy to be destroyed will be death. I hate death – I detest funeral homes – I have a hard time visiting the graves of my departed loved ones! Death is my enemy, and I am hoping to cheat death through the rapture!

I must tell you today, that there is a fate worse than death, and that is living a life devoid of purpose! Living without knowing “WHY” we are here is a terrible waste of time, energy, and resources! I lived 61 years without knowing my “WHY”! My “WHY” is, “*I innovate so others can have a greater generational impact!*”

It is my opinion, that the deepest craving of the human spirit is to find a sense of significance and relevance. Without purpose, victories are short-lived and defeats feel permanent. Without purpose, life has no meaning.

Where there is no purpose:

- There is no self-control...
- There is no moral conviction...
- There are no ethical boundaries...
- There is very little sense of responsibility...

THE “WHY” IS THE SOURCE OF FULFILLMENT

Everything in life has a purpose. Everyone on this planet was born with and for a purpose. It is this purpose that is the only source of meaning.

Without purpose, life is an experiment or a haphazard journey that results in:

- Failure...
- Frustration...

- Disappointment...

Without purpose, life is subjective, or it is a trial-and-error game, that is ruled by environmental influences, and circumstances of the moment.

In the absence of purpose:

- Time has no meaning...
- Energy has no reason...
- Activity has no precision...

If we discover our “WHY” and filter everything through the “WHY” life is:

- Full...
- Effective...
- Rewarding...

Discovering the “WHY” is essential because:

- It brings into view the original intent for the creation of a thing...
- It gets us focused on the end for which the means exists...

- It reveals the destination that prompts the journey...
- It defines the aspiration for the inspiration...

THE “WHY” GIVES CONTEXT TO THE JOURNEY

Every product is produced on purpose, for a purpose.

“We are His workmanship...” If we were created on purpose for a purpose, then it stands to reason, we must strive to be who we were born to be. What was the reason for which you were born? If you don’t know, don’t panic! We are going to help everyone in this church who desires to know the “WHY” of their lives, to discover just that this year!

If we discover, and become focused on the “WHY,” concern for doing the right thing, rather than just doing things right, must always guide us. Proverbs 20:5 *“The purposes of a*

person's heart are deep waters, but he who has insight, draws them out."

The context of the "WHY" looks like this:

- Plans may change, but the "WHY" never changes...
- The journey has many twists and turns, but the "WHY" remains the same...
- The road of life has many intersections, but the "WHY" provides the GPS for direction...
- The path we travel includes multiple detours, but the "WHY" gently guides us back to the assigned destination...

THE JOURNEY WAS DESIGNED FOR OUR "WHY"

Most people believe the road ahead is coincidental – that life just happens, and we must figure out how to respond to it. I disagree with that view of life. Our journey was designed for our "WHY".

Let me give us some life-changing truths:

- We are perfect for our purpose...
- The path we are on was designed for us...
- We were sent here for such a time as this...
- We are capable of fulfilling our purpose...
- We can hear him say, “*Well done, good and faithful servant...*”

We are the way we are, because of who we are!
Our births are evidence, that our purpose is necessary!

We are chosen! He (GOD) chose us! Ephesians 1:4 “*He CHOSE us in Him before the foundation of the world...*” We were “*Chosen BEFORE the foundations of the world were laid...*” The Greek word for Chosen is, “Eklegomai”. Ek = out LEGO = Logos (The whole written and spoken Word) MAI = I use or, I am used.

This means:

- We are a word from God... Our lives are to be a word out of the Word.
- We were chosen out of eternity past... We were sent from eternity into time because God had a specific reason for our being here right now!
- We are here to speak about God, and for God... What are our lives saying?

CONCLUSION:

The word for “***Chosen***” is Eklegomai = To pick out or to choose. A better rendering of this word is to say that “*God chose us out of Himself.*”

Jesus proceeded from the Father, and so has every son and daughter of God been pulled out of the Father, and sent into the earth – This is why the Word states that we were made “***In the image***” of the Father! We (Every one of us – Emphasize this) were sent into the earth on purpose, for a purpose!

Think of this :

- God picked Jesus...

- God picked the Children of Israel...
- God picked, prophets, kings and priests...
- Jesus picked His twelve disciples...
- God picked each of us... We are here on purpose, for a purpose !

(I want you to be thinking about which Bible character you admire the most and consider why you admire them)

FIND YOUR WHY

Sermon #Four

February 6, 2022

TEXT: Luke 1:26-35 (NKJV) *“Now in the sixth month the angel Gabriel was sent by God to a city of Galilee named Nazareth, ²⁷ to a virgin betrothed to a man whose name was Joseph, of the house of David. The virgin’s name was Mary. ²⁸ And having come in, the angel said to her, “Rejoice, highly favored one, the Lord is with you; blessed are you among women!” ²⁹ But when she saw him, she was troubled at his saying, and considered what manner of greeting this was. ³⁰ Then the angel said to her, “Do not be afraid, Mary, for you have found favor with God. ³¹ And behold, you will conceive in your womb and bring forth a Son, and shall call His name Jesus. ³² He will be great, and will be called the Son of the Highest; and the Lord God will give Him the throne of His father David. ³³ And He will*

reign over the house of Jacob forever, and of His kingdom there will be no end.”³⁴ Then Mary said to the angel, “How can this be, since I do not know a man?”³⁵ And the angel answered and said to her, “The Holy Spirit will come upon you, and the power of the Highest will overshadow you; therefore, also, that Holy One who is to be born will be called the Son of God.”

INTRO: You may be wondering what in the world the Christmas story has to do with your “WHY”. There are three things in this passage that will determine whether we discover and live out our “WHY”:

- The Word for the Why...
- The Favor for the Why...
- The Obedience to live out the Why...

THE WORD FOR THE WHY

In modern church culture everyone wants a Word from the Lord. Some people will travel

half way around the world to get a Word from the Lord.

Make no mistake about it, a Word from the Lord is essential to our “WHY”. There will be no “WHY” without a Word from the Lord.

I agree, that a Word from the Lord is important in various seasons of our lives, but the truth is, we have His Word in writing! It is called the Bible:

- 66 books...
- 1,189 chapters...
- 23,145 verses...
- 783,137 words...
- 1,050 commands...
- 8,810 promises... (7,487 are direct promises from God to humankind)

When we need a Word, we should go to the written Word first. All other words we receive should do two things:

- Confirm what the Lord has already been saying to us...

- Agree with the Word He has already given to us in the Bible...

Charles Spurgeon said, “*A bible that is falling apart usually belongs to someone who is not.*”

When we have a word from the Lord, we should treat it as a sacred trust. Psalm 119:11 “***Thy word have I hid in my heart that I might not sin against you.***” Many people know the Word but continue to sin. If one can read and understand the Word, yet continue to sin, what is this scripture speaking of? Let’s break this scripture down a bit:

- “***Word***” = Hebrew – Imrah – The Greek word is Rhema. These words are different than the Hebrew word Dabar, which in the Greek is Logos. Imrah is a personal, particular, whispered word. It is a secret conversation from the Lord’s lips, to our ears. These Hebrew and Greek words are not to be confused with the Hebrew word Dabar, which in Greek is Logos. Logos is a general

word – Its principles are for all - The Commandments are a Dabar, Logos word – A Dabar, Logos word is a universal word – It is a written word - It is a word that must be proclaimed... Make no mistake about it, the Dabar, Logos word is powerful and must be center stage in the life of one who wishes to live out their “WHY”, but the Imrah, Rhema word has a powerful place as well, for those who hope to discover and live out their “WHY”. Mary knew the Logos Word, but it was the Rhema Word that made this radical adjustment to her life, and caused her to live out her “WHY”.

- **“*Hid*”** = In the Hebrew, this word is Taman, and in the Greek, it is Thesaurus - What is a thesaurus? It’s a treasury of words. A thesaurus is all the words in a language - The antonyms - The synonyms -The nouns – The adjectives – The verbs – The Adverbs – The writer is saying, *“I take all of your Imrah, Rhema words and put them in the safety deposit box of my heart...”* We don’t

place junk in safety deposit boxes, we place highly valuable documents in our safety deposit boxes – Susan and I keep a written copy of all Rhema words – They create a sacred echo.

- The writer say's, I do this so that I will not “**Sin**” against Him – “**Sin**” = The Hebrew word is Chatta, and in the Greek it is Hamartia – This simply means “*To miss the mark.*” - We could paraphrase this scripture to say, “*The divine design You have spoken to me... I have treasured it in my innermost being... Because of this, I will hit the bullseye of your purpose and calling on my life.*”

This scripture is saying that “*If we treat His Word as a sacred trust, it will cause our lives to be directed into the purpose He has for us.*”

Mary treated the WORD from the angel as a sacred trust and it became the guiding principle for her life for the next thirty-five years!

THE FAVOR FOR THE WHY

When Gabriel told Mary, she was “*highly favored*,” he used the Greek word Charitoo.

Charitoo means:

- Grace...
- Delight...
- Pleasure...
- Goodwill...
- Lovingkindness...

The only other place this word is used is in Ephesians 1:6 “*To the praise of his glorious grace, with which he has blessed us in the Beloved.*” We could paraphrase this to say, “*Through His glorious grace, He has Charitooed us in the beloved.*” Look at your neighbor and say, “*Charitoo to you!*”

Without offending our former or current Catholic friends, the same favor that was on Mary to become the vehicle that brought God’s purpose into the earth, is the exact same favor upon our “WHY”.

Have you ever thought of yourself as someone as special as Mary? If not, why not? We are just like Mary! We have been chosen to carry the seed of His purpose (Our WHY), and to birth it in the earth!

God has Charitooed us in Christ! Charitoo to you!

We have been chosen to carry our own Rhema word! That whispered, specific word, that we have hidden in our hearts, so that we can give birth to it in the earth!

We have been given the favor to carry out our “WHY”, the question is, will we?

THE OBEDIENCE TO LIVE OUT THE WHY

Notice that Mary “*Pondered this*” – Where? “*In her heart!*” “*Thy word have I hid in my heart that I might not sin against thee.*”

Our hearts are where the battle for our “WHY” is won or lost! Once Mary “*Pondered – Considered – this in her heart*” she said, “*Be it unto me according to thy (Rhema) Word....*”

No rhema word will ever be given, without the Dunamis to carry it out!!!!!!! If we have a word and know our “WHY” He will furnish the Dunamis to do it!

The reason Mary pondered this in her heart is because she was “*troubled*” by the words the angel was speaking. This doesn’t mean she was upset by the words of the angel, it means “*she was surprised to hear such extravagant words said to her, and about her.*”

Mary was being asked to be obedient to an extravagant word being spoken over her life. Right here, she was being introduced to her “WHY”.

Think of this, Mary's "WHY" would be to take on the role of the matriarch of the savior's lineage! To be the Mother to God, playing a role as the savior of the world! No pressure!

Mary didn't have to:

- Pray concerning her decision...
- Council with the Rabbi...
- Get the intercessors involved...
- Do any research to make her decision...
- Get back to the angel about it...
- Have a church business meeting to vote on it...

She simply became obedient to her "WHY", and a peasant girl from Nazareth, who would have lived and died in obscurity, is made world famous by her "WHY"!!! Now 2,000 years later, I am preaching about her thousands of miles from Nazareth, in the world class city of Houston, Texas.

Here is where we get involved... Everything we have talked about up until this point, God did on His own... We can all agree on the wonder of such an extravagant word being spoken over a peasant girl from Nazareth... BUT our “WHY” carries the Rhema Word from the same God!

We are chosen by Almighty God to carry out our own extravagant, Rhema Word, in the earth!

- Do we know what that word is in our lives?
- Do we want to know what that word is in our lives?
- Are we willing to obediently to carry out the “WHY” no matter how extravagant it seems to be?

God has:

- A Word for our “WHY”...
- The Favor for our “WHY”...

The discovery of, and obedience to live out our “WHY” is totally on us!

CONCLUSION:

Mary:

- Exhibited Faith...
- Received the Word from the angel...
- Endured suspicion and ridicule...
- Birthed the Word in due time...
- Walked out the process of raising Jesus...
- Never received a second Word from the angel...

Mary received one Word from the angel and followed it for 33 1/2 years! She never went to another meeting looking for someone to “*confirm*” the word of the Lord to her!

How many words are we going to need before we discover our “WHY” and walk it out?

I am asking each of you to involve yourself in the process of discovering and embracing your “WHY” this year! (Susan and her team can help you with this)

FIND YOUR WHY

Sermon #Five

February 13, 2022

TEXT: John 1:1-5 (NKJV) *“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. ² He was in the beginning with God. ³ All things were made through Him, and without Him nothing was made that was made. ⁴ In Him was life, and the life was the light of men. ⁵ And the light shines in the darkness, and the darkness did not comprehend it.”*

INTRO: Today we continue with the fifth sermon in this series that is designed to help us find our “WHY”. Today’s text is a bit of a brain teaser:

- The Word was in the beginning...
- The Word was with God...
- The Word was God... (This is confusing unless you understand that the Word was a person – and that person is Jesus)

- All things were made by and through Him...
- Nothing was created that He didn't have a hand in...
- In Him was light...
- That light became the light of man...
- The light shines in dark places...
- Those in darkness cannot understand the light...

GOD IS WHO HE IS

I am going to make one of the simplest and most complex statements you have ever heard: “*God is God...*” I could preach the rest of my life on that one statement and never exhaust the knowledge of who He is, and never cover the same ground twice. If you really think about it, it is mind blowing.

God lives in eternity - We live in time. Eternity transcends time - Time is something God created and He is not subject to it:

- In the beginning – God was already there...

- Before there was a calendar, a watch, or a tic toc – God was there...
- Before there was a Monday, Tuesday, or Wednesday – God was there...
- Before there was an earth – God was there...
- Before there was a sun, moon, or stars – God was there...
- Before the sun rose or set – God was there...
- Before the moon glistened against a starry sky – God was there...
- Before there was an evening or morning – God was there...
- Before there was an angel or devil – God was there...
- Before there was a created being – A man, woman, boy, or girl – God was there...

Eternity supersedes time. God created everything. The supernatural created the natural. David said ***“He is from everlasting to everlasting.”***

Before there was a

- When...
- Where...
- Who...
- What...
- Or how... He was already God!

Before there was anyone there to tell Him He was God - He was God.

- As far back as I can see – God is there...
- As far ahead as I can see – God is there...

Whatever you are asking God to do in time, it's already settled in eternity. If God created time, we shouldn't take life for granted. If God created time, He is not going to work on our schedule. It may not be according to our time line, but God will certainly help us do what He sent us here to do – our “WHY”

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We get in a hurry because we are confined to time but God is eternal. And since he operates in eternity instead of time, He does not generally

get in a hurry to get anything done. He is an on-time God!

- He never comes too late...
- He never shows up with too little...
- He is rarely early...
- BUT He is ALWAYS on time...

WE WERE CREATED IN ETERNITY FOR OUR WHY

Jeremiah 1:4-5 (AMP) *“Then the word of the Lord came to me [Jeremiah], saying, 5 Before I formed you in the womb I knew [and] approved of you [as My chosen instrument], and before you were born I separated and set you apart, consecrating you; [and] I appointed you as a prophet to the nations.”*

God chose us when He was planning creation. Ephesians 1:11-12 (AMP) *“In Him we also were made [God’s] heritage (portion) and we obtained an inheritance; for we had been foreordained (chosen and appointed beforehand) in accordance with His purpose,*

Who works out everything in agreement with the counsel and design of His [own] will, 12 So that we who first hoped in Christ [who first put our confidence in Him have been destined and appointed to] live for the praise of His glory!”

If God created us in eternity for our “WHY” then we were not a mistake! Psalm 139:15-16 (AMP) ***“My frame was not hidden from You when I was being formed in secret [and] intricately and curiously wrought [as if embroidered with various colors] in the depths of the earth.”***

God pre-determined the exact time of our birth, where we would live, and who our family of origin would be. Acts 17:26 ***“From one man, Adam, he made every man and woman and every race of humanity, and he spread us over all the earth. He sets the boundaries of people and nations, determining their appointed times in history.”***

We were not only sent into the earth on purpose for a purpose, we were intentionally and thoughtfully created to be who we are for our “WHY”. Psalm 139:13-14 ***“You did form my inward parts; You did knit me together in my mother’s womb. 14 I will confess and praise You for You are fearful and wonderful and for the awful wonder of my birth! Wonderful are Your works, and that my inner self knows right well.”***

We are not only created by divine design and given a “WHY”, the day of our birth was chosen by Father God. Psalm 71:6 ***“Upon You have I leaned and relied from birth; You are He Who took me from my mother’s womb and You have been my benefactor from that day. My praise is continually of You.”*** (I got here as quick as I could)

**OUR WHY FLOWS FROM OUR
PATERNITY – HE IS OUR FATHER – WE
ARE HIS CHILDREN**

(Story of my dad introducing me as his boy)
90% of a child's identity comes from its father.

- It is a tremendous blessing to have a good earthly father...
- It is a tremendous challenge to have a bad example for an earthly father... (It makes the relationship between us and the Heavenly Father more of a challenge, but not impossible)

1 John 3:1 (AMP) ***“See what an incredible quality of love the Father has given (shown, bestowed on) us, that we should [be permitted to] be named and called and counted the children of God! And so we are! The reason that the world does not know (recognize, acknowledge) us is that it does not know (recognize, acknowledge) Him.”***

He is not just a Father – He is the PERFECT Father. Ephesians 3:14-15 ***“I kneel humbly in awe before the Father of our Lord Jesus, the Messiah, 15 the perfect Father of every father***

and child in heaven and on the earth.”

Translated from the Aramaic, this could be translated ***“The perfect Father of every people group.”*** The Greek word for “father” and the word for “family” are quite similar, which indicates that every family finds its source in the Father.

Whether you have a great or poor example for an earthly father, God has provided a path for us to partake of His divine nature, so that we can become all that we can be in discovering, embracing, and fulfilling our “WHY”. Romans 8:29-30 (The Passion Translation TPT)

“For he knew all about us before we were born and He destined us from the beginning to share the likeness of his Son. This means the Son is the oldest among a vast family of brothers and sisters who will become just like him.” ³⁰ ***Having determined our destiny ahead of time, he called us to himself and transferred his perfect righteousness to everyone he called.***

And those who possess his perfect righteousness he co-glorified with his Son!”

We were predestined to become like Jesus and bear the image of our Father... (Explain predestination)

We are to become just like Jesus and to interact with all our brothers and sisters in a concerted effort to bring about the will of the Father... He has made us like Him, not like our earthly representation of a father...

If we walk on the predetermined path of our “WHY” we will be “***Co-Glorified***” with Jesus... (“***Well done, good and faithful servant.***”)

A life altering moment is when we discover who we really are:

- We are heirs of God... (Children of God)
- We are joint-heirs of Jesus... (Nearest blood relative of Jesus)
- We are a holy nation...

- We are a royal priesthood...
- We are kingdom builders...
- We are world changers...
- We are revolutionaries, creating culture...

We use all kinds of excuses for not walking in our “WHY”:

- I’m a woman...
- I’m a minority...
- I didn’t finish school...
- I didn’t have a father...
- My momma didn’t raise me...
- I’m a felon...
- I’ve been an addict...

We build up a story to support who we think we are and use it to make excuses for not fulfilling our “WHY”.

Our Father has a high calling that has classified information about us, that we don’t have on ourselves. The information we seem to focus on

keeps us from our “WHY” but the information God has, supports our “WHY”. We are living according to the information that we grew up hearing, but Father God is attempting to direct our lives according to information that was established in eternity past!

We are the only ones that can sabotage our “WHY”. Are we going to allow what we grew up around, or what we were created to be, to become our eventual reality?

We need to decide to be ourselves, everyone else is taken! Nobody can do you, like you! You do you Boo!

- You are an original...
- You are one of a kind... (People say, “*You are something else.*”)
- Nobody has your fingerprint...
- Nobody has your voiceprint... (My dad’s dogs)
- Nobody has your style...
- Nobody has your flare...

- Nobody has your grace...
- Nobody has your creativity...

I so desire to see the people of this church rise up this year and begin to understand and walk in our spiritual paternity – Because this will lead us to discover and walk in our “WHY”. Doing this will not only impact the world and the Kingdom, it will impact how we live our lives, and interact with our families.

CONCLUSION:

Real life does not begin when our momma pushes us out. Real living begins when we find out “WHO” we are and “WHY” we are here.

Our mothers and fathers made us, but God created us. 2 Timothy 1:9 (Holman Christian Standard Bible HCSB) “***He has saved us and called us with a holy calling, not according to our works, but according to His own purpose and grace, which was given to us in Christ Jesus before time began.***” What was given to

us? Purpose and Grace! When? Before time began!

- Purpose is what He wrote in our book... (This is our “WHY”)
- Grace is what empowers us to carry out our “WHY”... (In doing so, we bring eternal decisions to life in the earthly realm – In earth as in heaven)

Who is ready to get on the right page, and in the right chapter, of your book, to bring destiny into reality?